

Hip/Glute Routine:

Always complete all reps on one side before moving to the other.

Unilateral Deadlift: 10-15 reps 2 sets - each leg

Stand tall with feet hips width apart. Begin to lean forward while at the same time raising the left leg behind you, balancing on the right leg. Abs and back should be engaged (tightened) and lifted leg engaged and strong, glute firing. Do not bend at the waist and then kick back. It should all be done in unison. **Hips should stay squared to the ground.** Don't open to the side of the leg the tis being lifted. Check out this video for help (you don't need the weights right now). Bending lift as far as you can without breaking form. Make sure you are slow and controlled with this exercise, and lean forward at the same rate that you are lifting your leg, like a pendulum. You can try holding a broom handle against your back and the back of your lifting leg. You should always feel it touching both of these spots, this way you know they are moving in unison. It is also good to do this exercise where you can see your reflection (mirror or window). Work on balance and stability and fluidity of movement.

Clamshell Progression: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each progression/each leg

P1. Lay on side, support head on bottom arm, spine straight, with knees bent at about a 45° angle, heels inline with spine . Keeping feet together, lift top knee up and open (15 reps). Make sure not to roll hips open. hips should always face forward.

P2. Keeping knees together, raise and lower heel. Making sure foot is in a dorsiflexion, toes pointed toward shins (15 reps).

P3. Raise entire top leg with knee bent at 45°. Keeping knee steadily in place in the open position, pulse just your heel upward for 15 pulses. Foot should be in dorsiflexion.

-Flip over and do the same on the other side.

Donkey Kicks: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each leg

Hands and knees on the floor with body in a table top position. Keeping knee bent at 90 degrees raise the heel of the right leg to the sky and lower to starting position. Make sure all leg muscles are engaged to maintain that 90° throughout the exercise. Keep back very flat and steady, hips tucked under to prevent low back sag. Think of trying to balance a glass of water on your back. Also make sure you don't bend at the elbows. Complete 15 reps on right side before moving to left.

Fire Hydrant: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each leg

Hands and knees on the floor with body in a table top position. Keeping right leg bent at 90 degrees, lift leg out to the side, like a dog peeing on a fire hydrant ;). Keep back very flat and steady, tuck hips under so your low back does not sag. Think of trying to balance a glass of water on your back while you are doing it so you do not "open" too much to the side of the leg lifting. Hips should stay facing the ground. Also make sure you don't bend at the elbows. We have a tendency to bend the opposite elbow of the leg that is lifting. Complete 15 reps on the right side before moving to the left side.

Monster Walk: 25 steps each way - 2 sets

With Thera-band around ankles so there is resistance when you step to the side, lower into a good squat position (chest up, knees not beyond toes, butt down), and step left 25 steps and then head back right 25 steps. Stay low the whole time, don't come up and down with each step. You can also do this without the Theraband just be sure to stay in that low squat the whole time. Do not stand up and squat down with each step.

Stair Squats: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each leg

Stand sideways on a stair with left leg hanging off. Flex left (hanging) foot toward shin and squat trying to tap left heel to ground. For this you must make sure your hips STAY LEVEL. Do not let the left

hip drop toward the ground as the left leg lowers. So, if you were to look at yourself in the mirror, your waistband would stay level. Also make sure your knee does not come past your toe on the squatting leg. Sit back in your squat, chest up. It is not a very deep squat movement and that is ok. We are looking for hip stability here. Complete 15 reps on the right leg before switching to the left.

Glute Bridge: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each leg

Lie down on your back, feet flat on the ground with knees bent, heels should be directly below knees. Raise hips in the air to form a bridge position with left leg raised straight up in the air. Arms flat on the ground for stability. Lower hips to hover above the ground then raise them back to the bridge position, keeping left leg in the air. This is one rep. Do 15 reps on the leg before moving to the other leg.

Hip Hike: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each leg

Stand on your right foot. With your pelvis in a neutral position, drop the left side so it is several inches below the right side of your pelvic bone. Activate your right hip muscle and lift your left side back to its neutral position.

Side Hip Bridge: 15-20 reps 2 sets - each side

Lie on your side with your feet propped on an elevated surface about 1-2 feet off the ground. Push your bottom foot down and lift your torso using your hip muscles while keeping a stable spine. Return to the starting position.

Iron Cross: 10-20 reps - each leg

Lie on your back with your arms out to your sides and swing your right leg across your torso and up to your left hand. Make sure to keep your shoulders flat against the ground, but you can rotate your torso and hips as you swing your leg toward your hand. Repeat the same movement for the left leg.

Scorpion: 10-20 reps - each leg

Lie in a prone position (on your stomach) with your arms out to your sides and swing your right leg across your back up to your left hand. Keep your shoulders and chest as flat against the ground as possible. Like Iron Cross, there will be a good amount of rotation in your torso and hips as you swing your leg toward your hand. Repeat the same movement for the left leg.

V-ups - 20 sec 2 sets (rest 15 sec between sets)

Legs can be bent in a "boat hold" type position with shins parallel to the ground. Slowly open up into a flat, hovering position, never letting your shoulder blades or legs touch the ground. Return to the starting boat pose position make sure your chest is up (heart to the sky) and spine is straight, no rounding your back while you are in the "V" position. Can modify by grabbing behind the knees in the "V" position.

Mason Twists with medicine ball (or weight of some kind) - 20 sec 2 sets (rest 15 sec between sets)

Same boat hold position. Make sure your chest is up (heart to the sky) and you are not rounding your back. Also be sure to really twist the upper body leading with the shoulder and not just moving your hands back and forth.

Back Extensions - 20 sec holds 2 sets (rest 15 sec between sets)

Lay on stomach. Stretch arms straight out in front of you as if you are trying to touch a wall with your finger tips. Legs stretched straight out behind as if you are trying to touch a wall behind you with your toes. Lift arms, head and chest while simultaneously lifting entire legs (quads included) off the ground, hold. Keep stretching toes and fingers out. We have a tendency to collapse and bend our arms and legs during this hold. Make sure to squeeze legs together and pull shoulders away from your ears (relax shoulders do they aren't all tight up next to your neck).